

Key Topic 1: The Birth of the State of Israel, 1945–63

Comprehensive Mastery & Exam Practice Booklet · Foundation to Grade 9 · 1945–1963

Pupil Name: _____

Class / Set: _____

Target Grade: []

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER (GCSE 9–1)

Marked by Teacher or Peer Verified

Assessment Component & Stem Focus	Format Style	Max Marks	Pupil Score
 Complete Knowledge Vault (All 80 Recall Questions)	Checklist	/80	_____
Round 1 (Stepped): Q1 Consequence (bombing of the King David Hote...)	Ladder	/4	_____
Round 1 (Stepped): Q2 Importance (UN Resolution 181 for the crea...)	Ladder	/8	_____
Round 1 (Stepped): Q3 Narrative Account (key events of the Arab-Israeli...)	Ladder	/8	_____
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q1 Consequence (Israeli attacks on Gaza in 195...)	Dual Track	/4	_____
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q2 Importance (Law of Return (1950) for the n...)	Dual Track	/8	_____
Round 2 (Dual-Track): Q3 Narrative Account (key events of the Suez Crisis ...)	Dual Track	/8	_____
Round 3 (Simulation): Q1 Consequence (formation of the United Arab R...)	Exam Hall	/4	_____
Round 3 (Simulation): Q2 Importance (creation of the Israeli Defenc...)	Exam Hall	/8	_____
Round 3 (Simulation): Q3 Narrative Account (key events leading to the end ...)	Exam Hall	/8	_____
TOTAL COMBINED EXAM MARKS:		/60	_____ / 60

Teacher / Peer Marker: _____

Date: _____

Overall Grade: [9 8 7 6 5 4]

EDEXCEL EXAM FAST FACTS & STEM BLUEPRINTS (OPTION P5 PERIOD STUDY)

TOTAL PAPER 2: 32 MARKS · 50 MINS

- **4-Mark Consequence (~6 mins):** *P-F-C Formula*. State **Point** clearly in sentence 1 → support with **2–3 detailed facts** → explain direct **Consequence Link** (why this mattered).
- **8-Mark Narrative Account (~12 mins):** *T-P-C Storyboard*. 3 linked paragraphs: **Trigger / Outbreak** → **Decisive Turning Point** → **Climax / Outcome**. Must use explicit causal connectives showing how Stage 1 caused Stage 2.
- **8-Mark Importance (~12 mins each):** *F-I-L Formula*. Identify **Factor** → provide **Information facts** → explain causal **Link** showing directly why it was important *for the named outcome*.

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Complete Knowledge Retrieval Vault · Questions 1 to 40 (No notes! Check your recall)

VAULT PART 1

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ 1. What crucial man-made waterway connects the Mediterranean Sea to the Red Sea, serving as a vital strategic chokepoint for international trade and oil?
[KT1] | ☐ 2. Which strategic maritime passage at the mouth of the Gulf of Aqaba was blockaded by Egypt in 1956 and 1967, acts that Israel considered causes of war?
[KT1] |
| ☐ 3. Which triangular desert peninsula connecting Africa to Asia was captured by Israel from Egypt in 1956 and 1967, before being returned under the Camp David Accords?
[KT1] | ☐ 4. Which strategic river forms the natural eastern boundary of the West Bank, flowing south from the Sea of Galilee into the Dead Sea?
[KT1] |
| ☐ 5. Which ancient and holy city, claimed as a capital by both Israelis and Palestinians, was divided between 1948 and 1967 before Israeli forces captured the Old City?
[KT1] | ☐ 6. Which elevated volcanic plateau bordering south-western Syria was captured by Israel during the 1967 Six Day War due to its dominant military vantage point over Galilee?
[KT1] |
| ☐ 7. Which narrow coastal strip bordering Egypt's Sinai Peninsula came under Egyptian military control in 1948, was captured by Israel in 1967, and became an epicenter of the 1987 Intifada?
[KT1] | ☐ 8. Which territory west of the River Jordan was annexed by Jordan in 1950, occupied by Israel in 1967, and became the central focus of Jewish settlement expansion?
[KT1] |
| ☐ 9. What was the de facto border established by the 1949 Armistice Agreements separating Israel from the West Bank, Gaza Strip, and Golan Heights until 1967?
[KT1] | ☐ 10. Which arid southern desert region accounted for over 55% of the total land area allocated to the Jewish state under the 1947 UN Partition Plan?
[KT1] |
| ☐ 11. Which southern Israeli port city on the Gulf of Aqaba provides Israel with maritime access to the Red Sea, East Africa, and Asia without using the Suez Canal?
[KT1] | ☐ 12. Which strategic fortified coastal town at the southern tip of the Sinai Peninsula directly commands the entrance to the Straits of Tiran?
[KT1] |
| ☐ 13. Which major freshwater lake in northern Israel, fed by the River Jordan, was a frequent source of border clashes with Syria in the 1950s and 1960s?
[KT1] | ☐ 14. Which region north of Israel's border became known as 'Fatahland' in the 1970s as the PLO launched cross-border rocket attacks against northern Israeli towns?
[KT1] |
| ☐ 15. What was the massive Israeli chain of sand-wall fortifications built along the eastern bank of the Suez Canal after 1967 to defend against an Egyptian crossing?
[KT1] | ☐ 16. Which capital city was subjected to a brutal three-month siege and heavy IDF bombardment in the summer of 1982, leading to the evacuation of the PLO to Tunisia?
[KT1] |
| ☐ 17. What was the political movement that emerged in the late 19th century advocating for the establishment of a sovereign Jewish national homeland in Palestine?
[KT1] | ☐ 18. What was the primary conflict between Arab and Jewish demands in Palestine as the British Mandate drew to a close in 1945?
[KT1] |
| ☐ 19. Which neighboring Arab kingdom east of the River Jordan, ruled by King Abdullah I, annexed the West Bank and East Jerusalem following the 1948–49 War?
[KT1] | ☐ 20. In 1945 at the end of the Second World War, what was the approximate demographic balance of the population living in Mandatory Palestine?
[KT1] |
| ☐ 21. Why was British Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin determined to maintain strict immigration quotas to Palestine in 1945–46?
[KT1.1] | ☐ 22. What tragic event on 22 July 1946 broke British civilian morale and accelerated their withdrawal from Palestine?
[KT1.1] |
| ☐ 23. Which refugee ship carrying 4,500 Holocaust survivors was intercepted by the British Royal Navy in July 1947 and forcibly returned to displaced persons camps in Germany?
[KT1.1] | ☐ 24. What did United Nations Resolution 181 (passed on 29 November 1947) propose for Palestine?
[KT1.1] |
| ☐ 25. What was the Jewish Agency's reaction to UN Resolution 181 compared to that of the Arab Higher Committee?
[KT1.1] | ☐ 26. What was the primary military objective of the Haganah's 'Plan Dalet' (Plan D) launched in April 1948?
[KT1.1] |
| ☐ 27. What notorious event on 9 April 1948 involved an Irgun and Lehi attack on an Arab village, causing widespread panic and civilian flight?
[KT1.1] | ☐ 28. Who read the Declaration of Independence establishing the State of Israel in Tel Aviv on 14 May 1948?
[KT1.1] |
| ☐ 29. What happened on 15 May 1948, the day after Israel declared its independence?
[KT1.1] | ☐ 30. How did the first UN-negotiated truce in June 1948 provide Israel with a decisive operational advantage?
[KT1.1] |
| ☐ 31. Which UN mediator was assassinated in Jerusalem in September 1948 by the radical Jewish militant group Lehi (Stern Gang)?
[KT1.1] | ☐ 32. What was the name of the official border established by the 1949 Armistice Agreements between Israel and its Arab neighbors?
[KT1.1] |
| ☐ 33. By the end of the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War, what percentage of mandatory Palestine was controlled by Israel?
[KT1.1] | ☐ 34. Which Arab military force proved to be the most effective and well-trained during the 1948–49 War, successfully holding the Old City of Jerusalem?
[KT1.1] |
| ☐ 35. What was the 'Sergeants Affair' of July 1947, which caused widespread outrage in Britain?
[KT1.1] | ☐ 36. What happened to the territory designated for an independent Palestinian Arab state under UN Resolution 181 following the 1948–49 war?
[KT1.1] |
| ☐ 37. Why was the Israeli supply corridor to Jerusalem known as the 'Burma Road' constructed in June 1948?
[KT1.1] | ☐ 38. What incident in June 1948 nearly sparked a civil war inside Israel when Ben-Gurion ordered the shelling of an Irgun arms ship off Tel Aviv?
[KT1.1] |
| ☐ 39. Which superpower was the first to grant de jure diplomatic recognition to the State of Israel in May 1948?
[KT1.1] | ☐ 40. Where were the formal 1949 armistice talks between Israel and Egypt, Jordan, Lebanon, and Syria held under UN auspices?
[KT1.1] |

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Complete Knowledge Retrieval Vault · Questions 41 to 80 (Self-mark on Pages 4–5)

VAULT PART 2

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ 41. What Arabic term, meaning 'Catastrophe', is used to describe the expulsion and flight of approximately 700,000 Palestinians during the 1948–49 War?
[KT1.2] | ☐ 42. What was the core principle established by UN General Assembly Resolution 194 in December 1948 regarding Palestinian refugees?
[KT1.2] |
| ☐ 43. Which United Nations agency was established in December 1949 to provide direct relief, education, and healthcare to displaced Palestinians?
[KT1.2] | ☐ 44. What landmark Israeli law passed in July 1950 granted every Jewish individual worldwide the right to immigrate to Israel and receive citizenship?
[KT1.2] |
| ☐ 45. What legislation passed by the Israeli Knesset in 1950 allowed the state to take custody of land and properties belonging to displaced Palestinian Arabs?
[KT1.2] | ☐ 46. What was Operation Magic Carpet (1949–1950)?
[KT1.2] |
| ☐ 47. Why was the 1952 Reparations Agreement signed between Israel and West Germany so controversial inside Israel?
[KT1.2] | ☐ 48. What term was used to describe armed Palestinian guerrilla raiders who crossed armistice lines to launch cross-border attacks against Israeli targets in the 1950s?
[KT1.2] |
| ☐ 49. What was the primary goal of Israel's military 'reprisal policy' developed during the 1950s under Moshe Dayan and David Ben-Gurion?
[KT1.2] | ☐ 50. Which controversial Israeli commando raid in October 1953, led by Major Ariel Sharon and Unit 101, resulted in the dynamiting of houses and 69 civilian deaths in a West Bank village?
[KT1.2] |
| ☐ 51. Why was King Abdullah I of Jordan assassinated by a Palestinian gunman outside the Al-Aqsa Mosque in Jerusalem in July 1951?
[KT1.2] | ☐ 52. What was the 'Lavon Affair' (Operation Susannah) of 1954 in Egypt?
[KT1.2] |
| ☐ 53. What was the 'Tzena' regime in Israel between 1949 and 1953?
[KT1.2] | ☐ 54. Under what legal framework did Palestinian Arab citizens who remained inside the State of Israel live between 1948 and 1966?
[KT1.2] |
| ☐ 55. What was the impact of the February 1955 Israeli raid on Gaza (Operation Black Arrow) that killed 38 Egyptian soldiers?
[KT1.2] | ☐ 56. Which demographic group of Jewish immigrants faced significant discrimination, poor tent encampments (Ma'abarot), and social marginalization upon arrival in 1950s Israel?
[KT1.2] |
| ☐ 57. Which Arab country formally granted full citizenship to the Palestinian refugees residing within its borders after 1949?
[KT1.2] | ☐ 58. What regional defense treaty, organized by Britain in 1955 to contain Soviet influence, was fiercely opposed by Egypt's Gamal Abdel Nasser as Western neo-colonialism?
[KT1.2] |
| ☐ 59. How did the United States support the young State of Israel economically in its immediate post-independence years?
[KT1.2] | ☐ 60. What was the 'Tripartite Declaration' issued by Britain, France, and the United States in May 1950?
[KT1.2] |
| ☐ 61. What political revolution in July 1952 transformed Egypt from a pro-British monarchy into a radical nationalist republic?
[KT1.3] | ☐ 62. What major geopolitical ideology did President Nasser champion, advocating the political, cultural, and economic unification of all Arab peoples?
[KT1.3] |
| ☐ 63. What landmark September 1955 agreement shattered the Western arms monopoly in the Middle East and alarmed both Israel and the United States?
[KT1.3] | ☐ 64. What decision by US Secretary of State John Foster Dulles in July 1956 directly triggered the Suez Crisis?
[KT1.3] |
| ☐ 65. On what historic date did President Nasser nationalise the Suez Canal Company during a fiery speech in Alexandria?
[KT1.3] | ☐ 66. Why was British Prime Minister Sir Anthony Eden so personally hostile toward Gamal Abdel Nasser?
[KT1.3] |
| ☐ 67. Why was France eager to join a military operation against Nasser in 1956?
[KT1.3] | ☐ 68. What secret collusion agreement was signed in October 1956 in a French villa between representatives of Britain, France, and Israel?
[KT1.3] |
| ☐ 69. What was Operation Kadesh launched on 29 October 1956?
[KT1.3] | ☐ 70. What did the joint Anglo-French ultimatum issued on 30 October 1956 demand of Egypt and Israel?
[KT1.3] |
| ☐ 71. How did President Dwight D. Eisenhower and the United States respond to the Anglo-French military intervention at Suez?
[KT1.3] | ☐ 72. What threat did Soviet Premier Nikolai Bulganin make against Britain and France in November 1956 during the height of the crisis?
[KT1.3] |
| ☐ 73. What innovative peacekeeping body was created by the UN General Assembly in November 1956 to oversee the withdrawal of invading forces from Egypt?
[KT1.3] | ☐ 74. What was the ultimate geopolitical consequence of the 1956 Suez Crisis for Britain and France?
[KT1.3] |
| ☐ 75. What major political victory did Gamal Abdel Nasser achieve despite Egypt suffering defeat on the battlefield in 1956?
[KT1.3] | ☐ 76. What conditions did Israeli Prime Minister David Ben-Gurion secure before agreeing to withdraw the IDF from Sinai and Gaza in March 1957?
[KT1.3] |
| ☐ 77. What was the 'Eisenhower Doctrine' announced by the US President in January 1957 following the Suez Crisis?
[KT1.3] | ☐ 78. What political union was formed in February 1958, uniting Egypt and Syria under President Nasser's single leadership?
[KT1.3] |
| ☐ 79. What dramatic event in July 1958 brought an abrupt end to the pro-Western Hashemite monarchy in Iraq?
[KT1.3] | ☐ 80. What secret assistance did France begin providing to Israel in the late 1950s as a reward for their military cooperation at Suez?
[KT1.3] |

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Official Mark Scheme & Knowledge Vault Answers · Answers 1 to 40 (Self & Peer Marking Bank)

MARK SCHEME 1

 **Quick-Marking Bank:** Cover this bank with your hand or a sheet of paper to test yourself against Pages 2–3, or use for rapid peer marking.

Answers 1–40

1. The Suez Canal

3. The Sinai Peninsula

5. Jerusalem

7. The Gaza Strip

9. The Green Line

11. Eilat

13. The Sea of Galilee (Lake Tiberias)

15. The Bar-Lev Line

17. Zionism

19. Transjordan (Jordan)

21. To preserve British alliances with oil-rich Arab states and prevent regional conflict

23. The SS Exodus 1947

25. The Jewish Agency accepted partition, whereas the Arab Higher Committee rejected it completely

27. The Deir Yassin massacre

29. Armies from five neighboring Arab states invaded the newly declared State of Israel

31. Count Folke Bernadotte

33. Approximately 79%

35. The Irgun executed two kidnapped British intelligence sergeants in retaliation for British hangings of Irgun members

37. To bypass Arab Legion blockades at Latrun and deliver vital food and weapons to besieged Jewish residents in Jerusalem

39. The Soviet Union

2. The Straits of Tiran

4. The River Jordan

6. The Golan Heights

8. The West Bank

10. The Negev Desert

12. Sharm el-Sheikh

14. Southern Lebanon

16. Beirut

18. Arabs demanded an independent democratic state based on majority rule, while Jews demanded an independent sovereign state to absorb Holocaust survivors

20. Approximately 1.2 million Palestinian Arabs and 600,000 Jews

22. The bombing of the King David Hotel in Jerusalem

24. Partitioning Palestine into separate Arab and Jewish states with Jerusalem under international control

26. To secure vital transport corridors (especially Tel Aviv-Jerusalem) and clear hostile villages prior to British departure

28. David Ben-Gurion

30. It allowed Israel to reorganize the IDF, train conscripts, and import modern weapons from Czechoslovakia

32. The Green Line

34. The Arab Legion of Transjordan

36. It was annexed by Jordan (West Bank) and placed under Egyptian military control (Gaza Strip)

38. The Altalena Affair

40. On the island of Rhodes

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Official Mark Scheme & Knowledge Vault Answers · Answers 41 to 80 (Self & Peer Marking Bank)

MARK SCHEME 2

 **Quick-Marking Bank:** Use for rapid recall checking against Vault Part 2 (Page 3). Log total correct recall items on Page 1.

Answers 41–80

41. The Nakba	42. Refugees wishing to return in peace should be permitted to do so, or be compensated for lost property
43. UNRWA (United Nations Relief and Works Agency)	44. The Law of Return
45. The Absentee Property Law	46. The secret airlift of approximately 50,000 Yemenite Jews to Israel
47. Many Israelis, led by Menachem Begin, viewed accepting German money as blood money for the Holocaust	48. Fedayeen
49. To deter future infiltration by launching disproportionately severe military counter-strikes against Arab border villages and bases	50. The Qibya Raid
51. Because he was suspected of conducting secret bilateral peace negotiations with Israel	52. A covert Israeli military intelligence plot to bomb British and American targets in Egypt to frame the Muslim Brotherhood and stop British troop withdrawal
53. A period of strict economic austerity, price controls, and food rationing to absorb hundreds of thousands of penniless immigrants	54. Under a strict system of Military Administration with curfews, travel permits, and special courts
55. It shattered Egyptian military pride and directly convinced President Nasser to seek modern weapons from the Soviet bloc	56. Mizrahi and Sephardic Jews from Arab and North African countries
57. Jordan	58. The Baghdad Pact
59. By providing extensive grants, private bond sales, and a \$100 million Export-Import Bank loan	60. A pledge to regulate arms sales to both Arab states and Israel to prevent an arms race and oppose border changes by force
61. The Free Officers Revolution led by Gamal Abdel Nasser and Muhammad Naguib	62. Pan-Arabism
63. The Czechoslovak Arms Deal	64. The abrupt withdrawal of US and British financing for the Aswan High Dam
65. 26 July 1956	66. Eden viewed Nasser as a dangerous fascist dictator ('Mussolini on the Nile') who threatened Britain's imperial oil lifeline
67. France accused Nasser of providing crucial military and financial support to the FLN rebels in Algeria	68. The Protocol of Sèvres
69. The Israeli military invasion of the Sinai Peninsula, advancing rapidly toward the Suez Canal	70. That both sides stop fighting and withdraw their forces 10 miles away from the Suez Canal
71. With fury, threatening to collapse the British economy by selling US sterling reserves unless troops withdrew	72. He issued veiled threats that London and Paris were vulnerable to Soviet rocket strikes
73. UNEF (United Nations Emergency Force)	74. It decisively demonstrated that Britain and France were no longer first-tier global superpowers and could not act independently of the US
75. He emerged as the heroic champion of the anti-imperialist Arab world, keeping control of the nationalised Suez Canal	76. Guarantees from the US and the deployment of UNEF troops ensuring freedom of navigation through the Straits of Tiran
77. A policy offering military and economic aid to any Middle Eastern nation threatened by armed aggression from Communist-controlled states	78. The United Arab Republic (UAR)
79. A bloody military coup led by Brigadier Abd al-Karim Qasim that murdered King Faisal II and Prime Minister Nuri al-Said	80. Construction of a secret nuclear reactor and reprocessing facility at Dimona in the Negev desert

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Round 1: The Stepped Ladder · Cause & Impact Studio (Foundation to Grade 9)

ROUND 1: STEMS 1 & 2

Question 1: Consequence (4 Marks)

P-F-C Formula · ~6 Mins

Explain one consequence of the bombing of the King David Hotel (1946).

 **Level 1 Launchpad:** Starter: "One consequence was that it shattered British domestic and political resolve to maintain the Palestine Mandate."

Facts to Include: On 22 July 1946, Irgun militants disguised as milkmen detonated explosives in the basement, killing 91 British, Arab, and Jewish staff and destroying the British administrative secretariat.

One consequence was that...

Specifically, (include 2–3 historical facts)...

This was significant because it led directly to...

 **Level 3 (Grade 9) Stretch:** Grade 9 Nuance: Evaluate whether the British decision to quit Palestine was an intended or unintended consequence of the Irgun's insurgency, and whether economic exhaustion after WW2 made withdrawal inevitable anyway.

Question 2: Importance (8 Marks)

F-I-L Formula · ~12 Mins · 2 Developed Explanations

Explain the importance of UN Resolution 181 for the creation of Israel.

 **Level 1 Launchpad:** Starter: "UN Resolution 181 was important for the creation of Israel because it provided essential international legal legitimacy for sovereign statehood."

Facts to Include: Passed by a 2/3 UN majority on 29 November 1947, allocating 55% of Mandatory Palestine to a Jewish state, 45% to an Arab state, and designating Jerusalem an international corpus separatum under UN administration.

PARAGRAPH 1: FIRST REASON FOR IMPORTANCE

One reason this was important was because...

For example, (deploy 2–3 precise historical facts)...

This was critical because it directly caused / led to...

PARAGRAPH 2: SECOND REASON FOR IMPORTANCE

A second reason this was important was because...

Specifically, (support with detailed factual evidence)...

Without this development, the outcome would have differed because...

 **Level 3 (Grade 9) Stretch:** Grade 9 Evaluation: Counter-factual analysis — explain whether Resolution 181 secured peace or whether its rejection by Arab states guaranteed that statehood could only be finalized through military warfare in 1948–49.

Question 3: Narrative Account (8 Marks)

T-P-C Storyboard · ~12 Mins

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).

You may use the following in your answer: • The invasion by Arab armies (May 1948) • The June 1948 truce (You must also use information of your own.)

Stage 1: The Outbreak (May 1948)

On 15 May 1948, armies from Egypt, Transjordan, Syria, Lebanon, and Iraq invaded simultaneously; Arab forces besieged 100,000 Jews in Jerusalem and advanced towards Tel Aviv.

Stage 2: The Turning Point (June 1948)

A 4-week UN truce enabled Israel to secretly import Avia S-199 fighters and rifles from Czechoslovakia, while David Ben-Gurion unified Haganah, Irgun, and Lehi into the IDF.

Stage 3: Outcome & Green Line (1948–49)

IDF counter-offensives broke the siege of Jerusalem via the Burma Road and secured 1949 armistices enclosing 79% of Palestine, creating 700,000 Palestinian refugees (the Nakba).

 **Causal Connectives Bank:** This triggered an immediate... • A decisive turning point occurred when... • Consequently, this enabled the IDF to... • The culmination of this development was...

PARAGRAPH 1: STAGE 1 — TRIGGER & OUTBREAK

The conflict / crisis began when...

Specifically, (deploy precise historical facts and figures)...

PARAGRAPH 2: STAGE 2 — DECISIVE TURNING POINT (EXPLICIT CAUSAL LINK)

As a direct consequence of this initial outbreak, a decisive turning point occurred when...

For example, (include key names, operations, or policy shifts)...

PARAGRAPH 3: STAGE 3 — CLIMAX & OUTCOME (EXPLICIT CAUSAL LINK)

This turning point directly triggered the final outcome when...

Consequently, the long-term impact on the region was that...

 **Level 3 (Grade 9) Analytical Glue:** Grade 9 Analytical Glue: Avoid writing a descriptive chronological story. Explicitly explain the CAUSAL LINK between the June truce breathing space and Israel's tactical dominance in the autumn counter-offensives.

Question 1: Consequence (4 Marks)

Independent Toolkit

Explain one consequence of the Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955.

Fact Vault (AO1)

- 28 February 1955: IDF paratroopers under Ariel Sharon raided an Egyptian military camp in Gaza.
- 38 Egyptian soldiers and 8 Israelis were killed, exposing severe Egyptian military deficiencies.
- Convinced President Nasser that Western arms embargos left Egypt vulnerable to Israeli aggression.

⚠️ **Trap:** Do not describe how the raid was carried out; focus solely on the political and military consequence for Nasser.

One consequence was...

Specifically,...

This was significant because...

Grade 9 Upgrade: Explain how this raid directly drove Nasser to seek Soviet-bloc weaponry, culminating in the September 1955 Czech Arms Deal and triggering the countdown to the Suez Crisis.

Question 2: Importance (8 Marks)

Independent Toolkit

Explain the importance of the Law of Return (1950) for the new state of Israel.

Fact Vault (AO1)

- Passed by Knesset on 5 July 1950: granted every Jewish person worldwide the legal right to settle in Israel as an automatic citizen.
- Doubled Israel's population within four years, absorbing 680,000 immigrants including European Holocaust survivors and Mizrahi/Sephardic refugees expelled from Arab nations.
- Created vital military manpower for the newly formed IDF and established demographic security against surrounding Arab majorities.

⚠️ **Trap:** Ensure your answer links directly to the survival and development OF THE NEW STATE, rather than writing a general history of immigration.

PARA 1: FIRST REASON FOR IMPORTANCE

One reason this was important was...

Specifically, (factual detail)...

PARA 2: SECOND REASON FOR IMPORTANCE

A second reason this was important was...

Without this development,...

Grade 9 Upgrade: Balance the military and demographic security advantages against the severe economic strain (ma'abarot tent cities, strict food rationing) it placed on the fledgling state.

Question 3: Narrative Account (8 Marks)

Chronological Anchor Toolkit

Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Suez Crisis (1956).

Stimulus Points: • Nationalisation of the Suez Canal (July 1956) • The Protocol of Sèvres (October 1956)

Chronological Anchors

July 1956: Nasser nationalises Suez Canal after US withdraws Aswan Dam funding.

Oct 1956: Protocol of Sèvres: Britain, France, and Israel secret collusion agreement.

Oct–Nov 1956: Israel invades Sinai; Anglo-French ultimatum and paratrooper landings at Port Said.

Nov 1956: US financial sanctions and UN pressure force humiliating Anglo-French withdrawal.

Causal Bridges

- "Nasser's nationalisation prompted..."
- "This led directly to secret tripartite collusion when..."
- "However, the military advance was halted when..."

Level 3 Standard: To achieve Level 3 (7–8 marks): Your account must explain how superpower intervention (US threats to collapse the British pound) converted an Anglo-French military victory into a political defeat.

The crisis / war began when...

A critical turning point occurred when...

Consequently, this led to...

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Round 3: The Planning Engine Room · Causal Architecture (Plan here, write on Page 11)

ROUND 3: ENGINE ROOM

1. 4-Mark Consequence Planning Grid: Explain one consequence of the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in 1958.

Point (Sentence 1)	2-3 Specific Historical Facts (AO1)	Causal Link to Outcome (AO2)
One consequence was that it encircled Israel with a unified Pan-Arab political union under President Nasser.	Egypt and Syria merged into a single state in February 1958, placing Egyptian military commanders in control of Syria's southern border with northern Israel.	This heightened Israeli security fears of a coordinated two-front war and pushed Israel to seek closer defensive ties with the United States and France.

2. 8-Mark Importance Planning Grid: Explain the importance of the creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) for the aftermath of the 1948–49 war.

Core Factor	Factual Information (Names, Dates, Treaties)	Direct Link to Named Outcome
The IDF was important because it dissolved competing political militias into a unified, disciplined national army under state control.	Established by David Ben-Gurion's Order No. 4 on 26 May 1948, forcibly disbanding the Haganah, Irgun, and Lehi (culminating in the Altalena affair), and introducing universal conscription.	This prevented factional civil war among Jewish groups, established firm civilian political control over the military, and created a permanent standing force capable of defending armistice borders.

3. 8-Mark Narrative Storyboard Grid: Write a narrative account analysing the key events leading to the end of the British Mandate in Palestine (1945–48).

Stage 1: Catalyst / Outbreak	Stage 2: Decisive Pivot	Stage 3: Climax & Outcome
Post-war Holocaust survivors sought entry; British White Paper strictly limited immigration to 1,500/month, triggering illegal Aliyah Bet ships (e.g. SS Exodus) and militant Jewish insurgency.	Irgun and Lehi launched guerrilla warfare against British infrastructure, climaxing in the July 1946 King David Hotel bombing and the hanging of two British sergeants in 1947.	Facing economic crisis at home and international outrage over turning back refugee ships, Britain announced in February 1947 it would surrender the Mandate, referring Palestine to the UN.

 **PRE-FLIGHT AUDIT CHECKLIST:** ☐ Did I include 2 precise dates/statistics per question? ☐ Does Q2 explain importance FOR THE SPECIFIC PROMPT? ☐ Does Q3 show how Stage 1 caused Stage 2?

KEY TOPIC 1: THE BIRTH OF THE STATE OF ISRAEL, 1945–63

Round 3: The Exam Pitch · Authentic Edexcel Continuous Prose Simulation

EXAM CONDITIONS

AO1 Knowledge (Level 3 Standard): Accurate, specific, and detailed historical facts deployed throughout.	AO2 Analysis (Level 3 Standard): Sustained causal focus, explaining consequence, importance, and causal flow.
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Question 1 (4 Marks):

Question 2 (8 Marks):

Question 3 (8 Marks):

TOP 3 FATAL EXAMINER TRAPS TO AVOID FOR KT1

• Partition (1947) vs Armistice (1949)

Do not confuse the 1947 UN Partition Plan (Res 181, which allocated 55% of Mandatory Palestine to a Jewish state) with the 1949 Armistice Green Line (which enclosed 79% following the 1948–49 War). Res 181 was never implemented as Arab leaders rejected it.

• The Turning Point of the 1948–49 War

The decisive turning point of the 1948–49 War was NOT superior Israeli numbers at the outbreak, but the 4-week UN truce in June 1948. This allowed Israel to import Czech Avia S-199 fighters and rifles, while David Ben-Gurion unified all militias into the IDF.

• Suez 1956: Military Victory vs Political Defeat

Britain and France achieved total military victory in capturing Port Said in November 1956, but suffered a catastrophic political humiliation when US President Eisenhower threatened financial sanctions, forcing an immediate withdrawal and elevating Nasser into a Pan-Arab hero.

SPECIFICATION PRACTICE BANK: 100% CURRICULUM COVERAGE

Every remaining specification bullet point tested below

Question 1: Explain one consequence of the conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.

Consequence (4m)

Question 2: Explain one consequence of the territorial changes resulting from the 1948–49 war.

Consequence (4m)

Question 3: Explain the importance of the refugee status of Palestinian Arabs for relations between Israel and Arab states after 1949.

Importance (8m)

Question 4: Explain the importance of US aid to Israel in the period 1949–1963.

Importance (8m)

Question 5: Explain one consequence of Nasser's leadership of the Arab world for relations with Israel.

Consequence (4m)

Question 6: Explain the importance of the Israeli attacks on Sinai in 1956 for Israeli security.

Importance (8m)

Question 7: Write a narrative account analysing the development of Israel's relations with Egypt between 1949 and 1956.

Narrative (8m)

PUPIL ACTION PLAN & TARGET AREAS FOR REVISION

My weakest topic in this unit was...

The specific facts / dates I need to re-learn are...

My target for the upcoming exam paper is...